

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter Sector Overview

Kansas — Kansas Department of Labor Jurisdiction — 2026-06-06

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Section 1: State Overview

State	Kansas
Labor Board	Kansas Department of Labor — Labor Relations Division (PNA/PERB)
Governing Law	
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	Kansas Department of Labor — Labor Relations Division (PNA/PERB) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — K.S.A. 44-831 (Kansas Labor-Management Relations Act, Article 8) (Kansas has been right-to-work since 1958. Applies to any NLRB private employer organizing — though KS charter schools are public employers under the PNA (K.S.A. 72-2218 et seq.), RTW principles do not apply in the same way to PNA-covered employees. Under PNA, no employee can be required to join a professional association.)
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — No card-check equivalent under PNA. Recognition through petition and election process administered by KDOL-LR Secretary.
Registry Sweep	— — 8 charter schools searched
Research Window	June 2026

Section 2: Charter Sector Landscape

Total charter schools in Kansas: 8 (NCES CCD 2023-24 (8 KS charter schools); KSDE directory; PublicSchoolReview 2026; U.S. News; Niche. All 8 confirmed open and operating.). Unionization census figures reflect confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
	8	100%	
	0	0%	

Charter Sector Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	2,347 students — 0.5% of state K–12 enrollment (481,626 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	1,159 students in network-affiliated schools — 49.4% of total charter enrollment
Students in Organized Charter Schools	0 students documented
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses†	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
Stride Inc.	Network‡	1	—	—	1,159
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Kansas		1		0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters	

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

1 network (type unclassified). Approximately 7 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Sector Overview

Findings are based on research as of 2026-06-06.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Kansas Department of Labor — Labor Relations Division (PNA/PERB) has exclusive jurisdiction. Federal NLRB does not apply to charter schools in Kansas. Kansas is a right-to-work state (K.S.A. 44-831 (Kansas Labor-Management Relations Act, Article 8)). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter Sector Structure

Kansas operates 8 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 2,347 students. 1 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Kansas. The largest networks by campus count are Stride Inc. (1 campuses in state). Approximately 7 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Media coverage and stakeholder position data not yet documented for this state.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

Kansas PNA agreements are negotiated annually (June 1 deadline). No school-level certification event exists — coverage is by statute. District PNA agreement is the primary research source. No PNA decisions mentioning any of the 8 KS charter schools were found in public records search.